



DO-IT-YOURSELF

ESTYLE

Turn Your **ANDROID SMARTPHONE** Into A PC

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There are times when you need a quick and handy alternative to your regular personal computer. Interestingly, your Android smartphone could do this job for you. Of course, you also need some related hardware and a mobile application to transform your smartphone into a full-fledged PC. Here is how to do it step-by-step!

What you need

1. A display monitor with HDMI support
2. A casting device (like Google Chromecast), or a Mobile High

Definition Link (MHL) cable and an HDMI cable

3. Mobile apps like Sentio Desktop and Null Keyboard
4. A Bluetooth keyboard and a Bluetooth mouse, or a USB OTG hub if the keyboard and mouse are USB-driven
5. A smartphone

Steps to follow

The setup process is quite simple. It is all about connecting the accessories and getting started.

Install the mobile app in your smartphone. A number of mobile

apps are available that give smartphones the feel and functionalities of a computer. Some of these include Sentio Desktop, Leena Desktop, Computer Launcher and Square Home 2.

We have used here Sentio Desktop, which is quite straightforward to set up. Install the application from Google Play Store and run to configure it. Once this is successfully done, go to the application and enable it. You will notice your Android user interface having a more PC-like feel, with a mouse cursor and Windows-like interface.



Fig. 1: Your phone turned into a PC



Fig. 2: Bluetooth-driven accessories

A little about Sentio Desktop app

Sentio Desktop mobile application, earlier known as Andromium OS, is currently in beta stage. It takes up the form of an operating system and gives an Android screen the desktop user interface when installed. For better performance, the application recommends certain specifications for the smartphone and display monitor in use. These include:

- A smartphone processor as strong as the Snapdragon 800 series
- At least 2GB RAM
- Android 5.0 or higher version
- 1080p resolution of the display device

The application comes with some basic features including a start menu, a Task Bar with a system tray, multi-window support, calculator and search.



Fig. 3: OTG-driven accessories